Data meshes make heavy use of both data lakes and data warehouses in various formats. Data meshes, in general, do not try to focus on any specific technology. We discuss this dichotomy a bit deeper in section 1.6. For now, let's try to keep spirits high and focus on the benefits of the data mesh.

1.2.3 Data mesh benefits

Let's analyze the potential of a data mesh implementation from two perspectives: through the eyes of the business decision-makers and the technologist.

THE BUSINESS PERSPECTIVE

From a business perspective, data itself is of little value. Worse, it means incurred costs! Does this sound like heresy? To understand that statement and, if needed, convey it to your business partners, you need to understand the levels at which people can understand reality.

A good approximation of this phenomenon is the DIKW pyramid, derived from *The Rock*, a play written by T.S. Eliot in 1934. This model represents data, information, knowledge, and wisdom as a hierarchical structure, in which each next element can be derived from the former. (See "Data Demystified: DIKW Model" by Anthony Figueroa, http://mng.bz/v60M.)

The data in this context is just a set of values (the storing of which costs money!). To derive value from this data, we need to build up the context, allowing for informed decision-making. The data mesh improves the robustness of the whole pyramid.

As we mentioned, having raw data is of no use to decision-makers. We could argue that they can download it to their laptops and analyze it themselves. This is true! This option has, however, two underlying assumptions:

- To download the data, it needs to be accessible.
- To ensure the value of any performed analysis, data needs to be as complete as possible.